

Google Glass: A Wearable Computer with Head-Mounted Display

Though head-worn displays for augmented reality are not a new idea, the Google Glass project has drawn media attention primarily due to its backing by Google. Also, this prototype is quite smaller and slimmer than the previous designs for head-mounted displays. Check out what Google Glass does and how it feels like



A man controls Google Glass using the touchpad built into the side of the device (Courtesy: Wikipedia)

MANUJ ARORA

In the present smartphone era, tech giants like Apple, Microsoft and Google are continually striving to make the smartphone smarter. Realising the highly competitive market and need to deliver more advanced features to the users, many smartphone developer companies have incorporated in the latest smartphones a new technology called augmented reality.

Augmented reality is the live, direct or indirect, view of a physical, real-world environment whose elements are augmented by computer-generated

sensory inputs such as sound, video, graphics or GPS data. The technology functions by enhancing one's current perception of reality.

Virtual reality replaces the real world with a simulated one. In contrast, augmented reality basically pulls the graphics out of your display screen and integrates them into real-world environments. This technology blurs the line between what's real and what's computer-generated by enhancing the vision. With the help of advanced augmented reality technology, by adding computer vision and object recognition, the information about the surrounding

real world of the user becomes interactive and digitally manipulable.

Some of the latest smartphones with augmented reality features are exemplifying the potential of augmented reality. Google Inc., renowned for setting technological trends, is on the verge of setting a new technological acme of augmented reality with its upcoming product called Google Glass.

What Google Glass does

The Google Glass device is essentially a pair of augmented reality goggles that run on Google's Android mobile operating system. The prototype was unveiled to public by Sergey Brin, co-founder of the company, at the I/O conference for computer programmers held in San Francisco on June 27, 2012.

The unveiled prototype includes a small see-through screen slightly above your field of view, which can display maps, record images and send texts. The product displays information in smartphone-like hands-free format and could interact with the Internet via natural language voice commands.

It is being developed by Google X Lab, which has worked on other futuristic technologies such as self-driving cars. Though head-worn displays for augmented reality are not a new idea, the project has drawn media attention primarily due to its backing by Google. Also, this prototype is quite smaller and slimmer than the previous designs for head-mounted displays.

Features of the device

In-built camera. Google Glass comes with an in-built camera. A button is